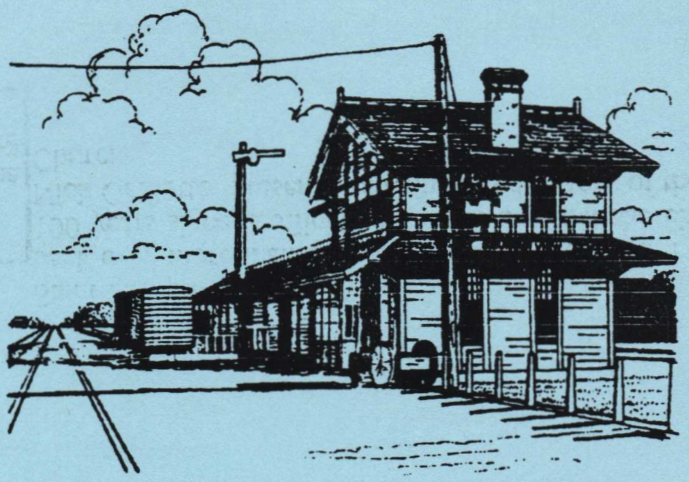
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1868

Eighth Annual Barbecue & Raffle August 5, 2001

The August 5, 2001 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will be our ***Eight Annual Barbecue & Raffle.*** The place will again be the patio area at the Mountain View Senior Center, 266 Escuela Ave.

The membership was mailed a flyer recently about the ***Barbecue & Raffle.*** The flyer included a form to clip and return, along with your check, to let the Association know how many to plan for and how much food to prepare. If you lost the flyer, don't despair! This Newsletter contains on page three all of the necessary information, so clip the form and send it in! We need to know that you'll be there!.

The important part of the day is the socializing, so come early. Bring your friends. If they are not members, we'll still welcome them. Perhaps they might even be persuaded to join. Anyway, let us know you're coming, We'll see you at the ***Eighth Annual Barbecue & Raffle*** on Sunday, August 5.

Congratulations

Belated Congratulations to our Special Member Lena Alameda who celebrated her 103rd Birthday on April 2, 2001. Many Happy Returns!

The May Meeting Celebrations 150 Years - First Presbyterian Church 100 Years - Saint Joseph Catholic Church

As the City of Mountain View approaches its Centennial Celebration, two other institutions within the City are also celebrating. The *First Presbyterian Church of Mountain View* celebrates 150 years since its founding, and the *Saint Joseph Catholic Church* celebrates 100 years since officially becoming a Parish Church.

First Presbyterian Church of Mountain View, at 150 years, is thought to have been the first protestant church congregation between San Francisco and San Jose. Barbara Kinchen presented an illustrated history of the church, where and when it was founded, the various church buildings, their locations and some of the ministers who have served the church and its congregation.

Saint Joseph Catholic Church claims roots that go back even more than 100 years. It is now celebrating 100 years since it officially became a parish church. Nick Galliotto presented an illustrated history of the Church.

The Day the Earth Shook in Mountain View By Carol Fischer

The plane crash occurred on Friday, February 1, 1957 at 3:25 p.m. Capt. Robert S. Mulvehill was attempting a routine landing at Moffett Field when his Air Force jet exploded and smashed into the home of Opal and Les Wright at 1039 California Street.

Mrs. Wright was preparing to go shopping when the Thunderjet ripped into the back of her home. She was able to escape safely through a front bedroom window. Immediately she reentered her home to retrieve her purse but the house was in flames and she made another quick exit. In the meantime, Les Wright was at work at his store at 181 Castro Street when he heard the explosion. Seeing the flames erupting from the vicinity of his neighbor hood, he rushed home where he found Opal standing outside their fire-engulfed home with a swollen ankle, a cut on her leg and a broken toe. He took her to Dr. Cody on Castro Street for treatment. The explosion and fire completely destroyed the home that had been in the Wright family since 1919.

Wreckage and debris affected other areas around town. Fires occurred at apartments at 420 and 424 Franklin Street as well at the Larex Meyers home at 1075 California Street. The second story of the Pedro Cabajal house at 427 Franklin Street was severely damaged by fire. Newspaper accounts report that this part of town resembled a wartime battle scene. Miraculously no one was injured. More wreckage rained down on Pearson Automobile Company at 492 Castro Street. Salesman E. I. Swanson and customer, Phillip Seaton, ducked for cover inside one of the cars as falling metal and shrapnel struck several other cars.

As the editorial for the February 4th edition of the Mountain View Register Leader pointed out, the plane crash could have been a true catastrophe as the accident occurred near a very congested area of town. Students and faculty of Mountain View High, Dana Street School or the Mountain View Academy could have been victims of the disaster. The merchants and shoppers of downtown Castro Street also escaped without incident. The editorial also pays tribute to Capt. Mulvehill, a young man of 32 and the father of four children. February 1, 1957 was a day of miracles and a day of tragedy for Mountain View.

New to the Mountain View History Center

From Member Frances Rodrigo Trimmer: Three 5 x 7" photos of the Rodrigo family – Modesto and Benedita Rodrigo, parents; Modesto and Benedita Rodrigo with seven of their children; Benedita Rodrigo and young daughter Rose picking prunes in Los Altos.

From Member Sam Duran: Three snapshots of the Akron at Moffett Field; 3 x 8" photo of the Macon dated Oct. 26, 1933; information from a 1941 Air Corps Basic Flying School Brochure, including pictures and a menu; miscellaneous newspaper articles about Moffett, hanger No. 1, 25th anniversary of Moffett; story about James F. Todd, member of the Macon crew when it went down in 1935.

From the Estate of Miss Jean Mockbee via member Eva Mockbee: Five framed photographs of Jean's parents, Jack and Eva Mockbee; scrapbook of newspaper articles; memorial funeral books for Jack and Eva Mockbee and Mrs. Bertha Bailey; newspapers and newspaper articles.

From Member Margaret Vidovich: 2001 Picture Directory of St. Joseph's Catholic Church containing pictures of staff, activities, organizations and members.

From Mrs. Marian E. Melendy: Mountain View Union High School yearbook for 1930 and 1931, the years her father, W. Price Robinson, taught athletics and general science at the school.

Mountain View Historical Association
Barbecue & Raffle
Sunday, August 5, 2001
1:00 P.M.
Senior Center
266 Esquela Ave.
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Menu:

Zesty Hamburgers
Condiments
Garden Fresh Green Salad
Delicious Potato Salad
Baked Beans
Watermelon

Cost:

Adults	$ 10.00 each
Children	$ 5.00 each
Raffle tickets	
6 for	$ 5.00

Bring your own:

Table Settings
Beverages

Agenda:

1:00 PM	Check in/Social Hour
2:30 PM	Barbecue
3:25 PM	Business
3:30 PM	Raffle

Detach Here and Return Form Below

Barbecue Order Form

Send This Form With Your Check to:
MVHA Barbecue
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Your Name and Phone: _____

Names of Guests: _____

Number of Adults _____ @ **$ 10.00 =** **$** _____
Number of Children _____ @ **$ 5.00 =** **$** _____

Total Amount Enclosed **$** _____

Please Mail By:
July 27, 2001
Thank You

Old Newspaper Items Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

100 Years Ago (1901): The Mountain View Band, 15 members led by W. A. Platt, present outdoor concerts at Castro and Front Streets. Plans are being made for building a bandstand.

Citizens of Mountain View held memorial services at the First Presbyterian Church in honor of slain President William McKinley. The church was draped in black and white and with flags and pictures of the President. Special speeches were given by B. E. Burns on McKinley as a Soldier, by Rev. Father J. J. Cullen on McKinley as a Citizen, by Professor F. L. Huff on McKinley as a Man and by Hon. C. P. Berry on McKinley as a Statesman.

Many San Franciscans are here for the summer. Eureka Baths, at the end of Stierlin Road attract 50 to 100 people each day.

Fourth of July was celebrated with a parade ending at Live Oak Park on Villa Street. During the afternoon and evening there were speeches, flag-raising, barbecue, races, games, dancing and fireworks.

George Ames and G. A. Pattberg have been canvassing the town to learn how many would subscribe to electric lights. They figure they could be justified in building and operating a lighting plant here if 250 subscribed.

Crossman and Orvis of San Jose were real-estate agents for the new town of Sunnyvale, "soon destined to become the leading city between San Jose and Palo Alto." It has a school house, general store, post-office and just-erected train depot.

75 Years Ago (1926): Camped's new movie theater on Castro Street showed the "Volga Boatmen" with the Presbyterian Church choir, under the direction of Neil Darrah, providing appropriate music.

Business and professional people put on a Saturday evening of music, fun and entertainment to celebrate the opening of the newly-paved Castro Street.

New Openings – Radio Grocery at the corner of Dana Street and Mountain Avenue by Mrs. E. B. Barnes and The Hub, a men's clothing store, at 234 Castro Street by Albert Borsch. Soon to open was Dinah's Shack which would feature a half spring chicken on toast for 50¢

Work of moving the Public Library from the lower floor to the second story of City Hall is almost complete. The City Clerk and the Justice Court will move down to the first floor.

The Chamber of Commerce has petitioned Souther Pacific to install a wigwag signal at the Bailey Avenue railroad crossing after an auto-train accident seriously injured Marengo Gonzales of Jackson Street.

Carl Anderson, member of Scout Troop 4 of the Adventist Church and son of G. H. Anderson was made an Eagle Scout — the first in Mountain View and the 36th in all of Santa Clara and San Benito Counties.

Fire destroyed the Hoo Hoo House at Monte Vista, a "picturesque dance resort of recent unsavory reputation." This was a huge log structure which had originally been the Oregon Building at the 1915 Panama Exposition in San Francisco. It had been dismantled and the logs shipped to MonteVista and reconstructed where it had been a popular dance resort for 10 years. After numerous complaints about liquor and other problems, county supervisors refused to issue a license to operate. A few months ago James Wylie of Mountain View and A.H. Oswald of Cupertino opened it as a private club, Peninsular Club. A five dollar fee allowed members to attend weekly dances for a period of three months.

50 years ago (1951): Auto-train accidents resulted in deaths of Mrs. Dorothy Benefiel at Alviso Road crossing in May, two Permanente Company workers at the Ada Avenue crossing in August and a week later at Rengstorff Avenue sixteen-year-old Doris Stephens died.

The new $1,000,000 Ferry-Morse Seed Company plant opened at 111 Whisman Road after 18 months construction. The largest building is the length of two football fields.

Miles & Sons Trucking, denied permits to move from 700 Alviso Road, near Church Street, to Alviso Road

at Evelyn will move instead to a s ix acre site on the west side of Mathilda Avenue near Bayshore Highway.

Seibert Buick and Pearson Auto have announced that their Service and Parts departments would no longer b open on Saturdays.

William Kuenstler, manager of the Thrifty Grocery Stores at 194 and 295 Castro Street, will build a Thrifty Outlet Store at the corner of Fairmont and Hope Streets and then close the 295 Castro store.

New Openings — Ruby's Chicken Shack at 835 El Camino; Rocky's Pizzeria 7 Restaurant at 939 El Camino and Ralston's Apparel Shop, offering a complete line of women's clothing, at the corner of Castro and Dana Streets. After 26 years on View Street, the Ideal French Laundry moved to a ne building at 113 Escuela Avenue. Arthur Nougues is the owner.

Marymead, the Fretz home at Grant and Fremont Roads, is being readied for use as a training hospital for doctors, nurses and pharmacists. Mrs Paul Fretz recently turned the 10–acre site and 20 room house over to the Association of Catholic Medical Missionaries.

Shirley Aristo was voted Queen of the Harvest Festival, the third consecutive year the Spanish colony's candidate has won the crown. City Council received a letter after the Festival from Rev. Darling, Father James Doyle and Rev. D. V. C. Black objecting to the location of the carnival at the rear of St. Joseph's Church. Noise from the carnival disrupted services at the three downtown churches and the "riffraff" it attracted were disrespectful to church property.

25 Years Ago (1976): West Coast Federal Savings opened at 401 Castro Street, corner of California, in a tile and stucco octangular structure.

After the bus kidnaping near Chowchilla in July, Mountain View School District considered installing citizen band radios in the 12 busses and base station. The idea was rejected because of high costs, they are too easily stolen and would not be able to be operated if the driver was incapacitated..

In the last few months Mountain View has approved four commercial racquet ball centers: Middlefield and Whisman Roads, adjacent to Mayfield Mall and a 16-court center on San Antonio Circle near the Old Mill Shopping Mall. The Old Mill is 60% leased and will open in October with anchor tenants La Posada Restaurant, Fargo's Italian Foods, Jumping Frog Saloon and Upstart Crow Bookstore. The six-theater complex at the Old Mill opened in August and took in $37,000 opening week.

A site at the corner of Villa and Franklin Streets has been selected for the new police headquarters building.

Street Talk

Do you have questions or information about Mountain View's street names? Please contact the Newsletter Editor.

Eunice, Franklin and Sleeper Avenues are named after members of the early Sleeper family. Fran Sleeper (1822-1872) and Eunice Sleeper (1814-1901) owned several hundred acres running from El Camino Real at Grant south to include the above named roads. The Sleepers came from Boston in the early 1850s. Mr. Sleeper was a Santa Clara County Supervisor from 1864 to 1868. Frank P. Beverly, Justice of the Peace in Mountain View for many years, was raised by his aunt, Mrs. Sleeper. Much interesting information about the family will appear in the book on Mountain View History due out next year.

Does anyone have the answer to the location of a Maybelle Avenue? The 1926 directory shows that Alfred Wilcox and a Max Wohlberg both lived on that Avenue. Those names and that avenue do not appear in the 1930 directory.

Thanks

Thanks to Eva Mockbee for her generous donation to the Memorial Fund in memory of her late sister-in-law Jean Mockbee.

Treasurer's Report

Hilton Brown

The financial status of the Mountain View Historical Association is given in the tables below. Primary sources of revenue for the Association are Annual Dues which arrive primarily in the fourth quarter, the Small Brewers Festival and the Annual Barbecue which occur in the third quarter. We normally spend somewhat more than we take in during the second quarter. Equity decreased by $320.57 during this second quarter.

Income & Expense

April 1, 2001 - June 30, 2001

Opening Balance		$ 68,282.61
Income		
Annual Dues	$ 37.00	
Life Members	200.00	
Interest	349.85	
Sales	14.00	
Special Event	100.00	
Total Income		700.85
Expense		
Business Expense		
Donor Solicitation	$ 297.00	
General Overhead	100.00	
Meeting Expense	10.44	
Membership Exp	69.67	
Material for Sale	137.59	
Newsletter Exp.	297.72	
History Project	2,437.50	
Total Business Exp.		3,349.92
Ending Balance		$ 65,633.54

Fund Balances

June 30, 2001

Fund Balances	
Adobe Fund	$ 1,078.73
Life Member Fund	7,941.00
Memorial Fund	519.14
Operating Reserve Fund	3,000.00
Significant Debts Payable	1,218.75
Publication Fund	50,000.00
Unencumbered (Equity)	1,875.92
Total Funds	$ 65,833.54

Disposition of Funds

June 30, 2001

Bank of Los Altos Checking Account	$ 12,534.24
Petty Cash	100.00
Bank of Los Altos Certificates of Deposit	52,999.30
Total	$ 65,633.54

Check Your Address Label

The address label affixed to this Newsletter has a code on the upper right. It looks something like this:

-[2001][AF]

The number in brackets is the year, according to the Treasurer's records, through which your dues have been paid. If the year on your label is [2000], or earlier, you will be dropped from our mailing unless we hear from you.

Membership Report
by June Casey

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	93
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Regular Memberships	185
Total Memberships	270

New Life Members:
Louis F. Renner
Lorraine A. Wormald

Association Officers and Executive Committee

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Craig Holden
Sergeant At Arms	John Viscovich
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer & Editor	Hilton Brown
Membership	June Casey
Programs & Publicity	Liz & Mario Ambra
Hospitality	Elizabeth Engberg
Memorial/Remembrance	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Pat Figueroa
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Life, Honored and Special Members

Honored Member

Chris Castro

Special Member

Lena Alameda

Life Members

Lennart Ahlkvist
Mario Ambra
May E. Armanini
John Arrillaga
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Flora Brown
Hilton Brown
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Alice Churin Carvo
June Casey
William A. Dale
June de Larios
Cliff Del Carlo
Joseph Diaz
Kevin C. Duggan
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carole Fischer
Tom Frankum
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Ed Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Audry Jarvis Hoke
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Leo E. Kalcic
R. Michael Kasperzak Jr.
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Barbara Krzyczkowska
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Thomas E. Miller
Frances Churin Mills
Eva Mockbee
Betty C. Monroe
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Don Newfarmer
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Richard J. Peery
Harry Pinto
Ida Pinto
Milan Popovich
Massimo Prati
John P. Puppo
Louis F. Renner
Patricia J. Reyburn
Mark Rogge
Vivian Schatz
Robert C. Schick
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Austin Spencer
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Sally Moore Taboada
Hip Telmont
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Paula Weaver
Robert Weaver
Denise Williams
Bill Wissell
Lorraine A. Wormald
Mary Lou Zoglin

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

REGULAR MEETING

EIGHTH ANNUAL BARBECUE & RAFFLE

SUNDAY, AUGUST 5, 2001
1:00 P.M.

MOUNTAIN VIEW SENIOR CENTER
266 ESCUELA

PATIO/MAIN HALL AREA

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____
Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

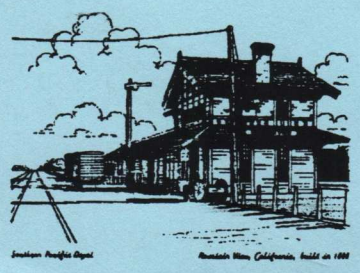
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